

The Great Barrier Reef: answers

Year 4 · 14 marks. Accept any sensible answer that is backed up by the text.

1. Queensland. (1 mark)

Finding information. A fact to find in the first section.

2. About 2,300 kilometres. (1 mark)

Finding information. Finding a number that is stated near the start of the text.

3. To lose colour (the corals turn pale and may die). (2 marks)

Word meaning. The meaning is explained in the same sentence, so the child uses the clue.

4. Each polyp makes a hard limestone skeleton. When polyps die, the skeletons stay and new polyps grow on top, and over thousands of years this builds a reef. (2 marks)

Explaining from the text. Explaining a process in the child's own words from a whole paragraph.

5. To show that the Reef is much bigger and more complicated than people might think, because it is made of thousands of reefs and islands. (2 marks)

Inference. Thinking about why a writer chose to include a fact.

6. The text says warm seas make corals bleach and may kill them, so very warm water harms the reef. (2 marks)

Inference. Using a cause stated in the text to explain a risk.

7. 1. A polyp makes a hard skeleton around itself. 2. The polyp dies and its skeleton stays behind. 3. New polyps grow on top of the old skeletons. 4. Over thousands of years, a reef forms. (2 marks)

Sequencing events. Putting a process in order shows the child understood how the pieces fit.

8. One point for what the Reef is (a huge reef system made of thousands of reefs, built by tiny animals); one for another main idea (it is home to lots of sea life and needs protecting from dangers such as warm seas). (2 marks)

Summarising. A good summary keeps the main ideas and leaves out small details.